Teacher and cover plan — Studio skills and safe workshop practice

Pathway: TRACK · Week 2 Part 2 · Big question: How do we score, cut, and laminate heavy card safely to build rigid architectural relief?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Demonstrate safe workshop setup using cutting mats, safety rulers, and controlled scoring.

• Construct raised structural girders using laminated card strips and slotted gusset joins.

• Apply a unifying tonal wash or dry-brush primer across the assembled relief study.

Studio kit: A4 self-healing cutting mats, metal safety rulers, scoring blades/craft scissors, greyboard bases, corrugated card, PVA glue, dark acrylic primer

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Look at the studio safety diagram on your desk. Where must your non-cutting hand always stay when using a safety ruler?

Starter question: Why is making three light scoring passes along a ruler safer and neater than pressing down with all your force in one go?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Safe stance and straight strip cutting: I stand up over my cutting mat, tuck my fingers behind the safety ruler guard, and cut even girder strips.

Step 2: Laminate and add gusset plates: I glue two strips together for a deep main beam and lock diagonal braces with triangle gusset plates.

Step 3: Apply dark primer and metallic skim: I brush a thin dark grey coat over the card joins so the whole structure reads as solid ironwork.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Safely cut laminated girder frame with gusset corners and unified dark wash.

Independent: Three-level laminated truss relief primed, highlighted, and logged.

Aspire: Graduated three-level relief span with weathered finish and technical annotation.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Count all cutting/scoring tools out and back in using numbered table blocks; model the standing safety-ruler grip before distributing trays.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review safe classroom management of cutting mats, safety rulers, and cardboard

lamination.